

Can you sing your song?

A jazzy, action song for Key Stage 1

Can you sing your song like Ella? (Ella Fitzgerald)
Can you sing your song like that?
Can you sing your song like Ella?
You're a really swinging cat.

Scat verse – either sing the melody with new sounds or improvise your own melody.

Can you blow your trumpet like Dizzy? (Dizzy Gillespie)
Can you blow your trumpet like that?
Can you blow your trumpet like Dizzy?
You're a really bopping cat.

Scat verse – imitate the sound of the trumpet / mime playing the trumpet.

Can you pluck your bass like Eddie? (Eddie Gomez)
Can you pluck your bass like that?
Can you pluck your bass like Eddie?
You're a really groovy cat.

Scat verse – imitate the sound of the double bass / mime playing the double bass.

Can you hit your drums like Terri? (Terri Lyne Carrington)
Can you hit your drums like that?
Can you hit your drums like Terri?
You're a really funky cat.

Scat verse – imitate the sound of the drums / mime playing the drums.

YEAH!

Teacher's note

'Scat' or 'Scatting' is the technique used by jazz vocalists when they use their voice to imitate the sound of an instrument. They improvise wordless melodies using sounds or nonsense syllables. The syllables they choose reflect the articulations (long/short sounds) played by an instrumentalist.



Some sounds to try - Scooby – dooby. Be-bop. Diddley. Va-voom. Bap. Sshh. Boom. Hey.

Listen to the demo track to get some ideas and try singing along with this version.

Extension ideas –

1. Using the backing track (music, no vocals) add different jazz musicians to the song e.g.
Can you play your sax like Charlie (Parker)
Can you strum your guitar like Django (Reinhardt)

Or use the names of the children in your class
Can you sing your song like Fred, Alisha, Imran etc



2. Active Listening - Listen to the Spotify playlist featuring the musicians in the song
<https://open.spotify.com/playlist/2HFwRLELvlVLVvmlnjs6P3?si=5e5e364387554a6c>

Ask the children to name the instruments that they can hear?

Can they describe the timbre (sound quality) of these instruments?

Ask them about the use of Dynamics (loud and quiet) and Tempo (fast and slow) in each piece.

How do these help to create the mood and character of each piece?

Artist / Name of piece	Instruments	Points to listen for
Ella Fitzgerald Old Mother Hubbard	This is an example of a Big Band. Rhythm section – piano, guitar, double bass, drum kit. Trumpets, saxophones, trombones.	After singing the verse of the song, Ella Fitzgerald sings an improvised scat solo. The dynamics are generally loud and the tempo is medium. The mood is happy, bright and fun – to compliment the nursery rhyme.
Dizzy Gillespie Manteca	This is an example of a Big Band playing Afro-Cuban jazz so there is the addition of conga drums to the line-up. Rhythm section – piano, guitar, double bass, drum kit, conga. Trumpets, saxophones, trombones.	Listen to the way the track builds up by layering repeated patterns (riffs). Dizzy Gillespie plays the solo trumpet interjections. You can also hear an improvised tenor saxophone solo. The dynamics are generally loud and the tempo is medium. The mood is bright and happy and might make you want to get up and dance.
Eddie Gomez You must believe in Spring	This an example of a jazz duo - Piano and Double bass.	The piano plays a solo introduction and is then joined by the double bass. The tempo is slow and free. The dynamic is quiet and creates a reflective mood. Listen out for Eddie Gomez's improvised bass solo before the piano solo. Listen to the way that the tempo and dynamics change - get faster and louder before returning to the slower tempo and quieter dynamic at the end.
Terri Lyne Carrington Wind Flower	This is an example of a Small band. Flute Trumpet Electric Guitar Electric Bass Drums	The introduction starts with the rhythm section (guitar, bass and drums) before being joined by the front line (flute and trumpet) Listen out for improvised solos from the guitar, flute and trumpet.

		The tempo is medium and the dynamics rise and fall as the piece evolves.
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H Summerfield

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5 Can you sing your song like Ella? You're a real - ly swing-ing cat